

Microsoft SQL Server Audit Checklist

Access Control

- ☐ Only approved users can log in to the SQL Server
- ☐ Each user has their own account
- ☐ Users only have access to what they need (role-based access)

Login and Password Security

- ☐ Strong passwords are required
- ☐ Windows or mixed authentication is used
- ☐ Failed logins are tracked and reviewed

Permissions Review

- ☐ No unnecessary admin-level roles
- ☐ Users only have access to the right databases and objects
- ☐ Inactive or old user accounts are removed

Server Settings

- ☐ Server is fully updated and patched
- ☐ Unused features (like xp_cmdshell) are turned off
- ☐ Extra services are disabled if not needed

Data Encryption

- ☐ Transparent Data Encryption is enabled
- ☐ Data sent over the network is encrypted
- ☐ Backups are encrypted and stored safely

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Audit and Logging

- ☐ Audit logs are turned on
- ☐ Logs are checked regularly for unusual activity
- ☐ Logs are stored securely

Backups

- ☐ Backups are running regularly
- ☐ Backups are tested with recovery drills
- ☐ Backups are stored securely (off-site or cloud)

Server Security

- ☐ SQL Server is installed on a secure server
- ☐ Protected by a firewall and not exposed to the public

Monitoring and Alerts

- ☐ Alerts are set up for failed logins or strange activity
- ☐ Monitoring tools are in place
- ☐ Changes in permissions or access are tracked